

Launch Estimate — Effort, Timeline & Cost

GamerGain / PlayEarning Nexus — PWA (web) + Android + iOS

Prepared July 25, 2026. Grounded in the actual codebase and launch docs. Cost is calculated at a flat rate of **125 developer hours** × **\$75/hour** = **\$9,375** for the full launch of all three surfaces.

The short version

You are **not building an app** — you are **configuring, deploying, and shipping one that is already written**. The frontend (208-page React PWA), the Deno backend (526 function routes, 239-table Postgres schema), auth, the agent system, the payout/economy logic, and the security hardening are done and on GitHub. What remains is standing it up on live infrastructure, wiring your own provider keys, testing money flows end-to-end, and submitting the mobile apps.

Headline	Value
Developer effort (full launch: PWA + Android + iOS)	125 hours
Hourly rate	\$75 / hour
Development cost	125 × \$75 = \$9,375
Calendar to web live	~2-3 weeks
Calendar to both app stores	~4-6 weeks
Monthly cost at launch (low traffic)	~\$100-700/mo
Monthly cost at 100k users	~\$3,000-8,000/mo

The **\$9,375 is developer labor only**. Fixed fees and monthly hosting are separate and listed below.

1. What "launch" includes (scope)

All three surfaces live and working end-to-end:

- **Web PWA** — the React app on a domain with HTTPS, installable, talking to the live backend.
- **Backend + database** — the Deno service on a host, connected to managed PostgreSQL with the schema loaded, the cron scheduler on, and every integration key wired.
- **Native apps** — the Capacitor wrappers for **Android** (Play Store) and **iOS** (App Store), submitted and approved.

Plus the non-code prerequisites: third-party accounts and keys, legal pages at public URLs, and passing each store's review.

2. Developer effort — 125 hours, phase by phase

One intermediate full-stack developer, priced at \$75/hour. This is the full path (both app stores + a load test), which totals **125 hours = \$9,375**.

--	--	--	--

#	Work	Hours	Cost (× \$75)
1	Accounts & API keys (Postgres, OpenAI, SendGrid, S3, Stripe/PayPal, Twilio, BitLabs)	12	\$900
2	Deploy backend (container + managed Postgres + schema) + scheduler	14	\$1,050
3	Pre-deploy validation (<code>npm run build</code> , <code>deno check</code>) + fixes	6	\$450
4	Deploy frontend (static host, SPA fallback, domain + SSL)	8	\$600
5	Payments end-to-end, sandbox → live (inbound + partner payouts)	15	\$1,125
6	Survey loop live test (BitLabs → credit → agent → oversight)	10	\$750
7	Android wrapper + Play Store submission	22	\$1,650
8	iOS wrapper + App Store submission	12	\$900
9	QA pass + fixes (auth, store, referrals, legal)	15	\$1,125
10	Load test + resize from real numbers	11	\$825
	Total	125	\$9,375

3. One-time costs

Item	Cost
Developer labor (125 hrs × \$75)	\$9,375
Google Play Console (one-time)	\$25
Apple Developer Program (first year)	\$99
Domain name	~\$12-15
Legal review (recommended — privacy/terms + earn-money framing)	\$500-2,500
Typical one-time total	~\$10,000-12,000

iOS builds need a Mac; the included cloud-CI setup builds iOS with no Mac purchase, so that's \$0 added.

4. Recurring monthly costs

Early launch (low traffic): managed Postgres \$0-70, backend host \$14-50, frontend \$0-20, Redis \$0-15, email \$0-20, S3 \$1-10, plus AI/LLM usage \$50-500. **Realistic early all-in: ~\$100-700/mo.**

At scale (~100k users, projection): RDS \$700-1,200, ECS Fargate \$300-1,200, Redis \$200-500, ALB/CloudFront/S3 \$150-500 → **infra ~\$1,500-3,500/mo**, plus provider/LLM usage (often the largest line) → **~\$3,000-8,000+/mo all-in.**

Transaction fees: ~2.9% + \$0.30 per card/PayPal transaction (pass-through, scales with revenue).

Ongoing: Apple **\$99/yr**. Cost controls already built in: every one of the 76 agents has a pinned model and a daily USD cap.

5. Timeline (calendar, not just hours)

Milestone	Calendar
Backend + web PWA live	~2-3 weeks

Android in Play Store	~3–4 weeks
iOS in App Store	~4–6 weeks (Apple review is slower; earn-money apps get extra scrutiny)
Legal review	in parallel (not developer time)

External waits you don't control: live-payment key approvals, app-store review, lawyer turnaround.

6. Key assumptions & risks

- **You supply the accounts and keys** (every var is enumerated in [CONFIG-AND-SECRETS.md](#)).
- **iOS requires a Mac** — the cloud-CI setup handles this at \$0, so no purchase needed.
- **Earn-money app = extra app-store scrutiny.** Provide a demo login; frame rewards as skill/merit-based.
- **LLM cost is the monthly unknown** — it tracks engagement; watch the per-agent caps.
- **The 100k figure is a projection** — confirm with the load test before relying on it.

7. Bottom line

Full launch of **PWA + Android + iOS**, all features, at **125 developer hours × \$75/hour = \$9,375** in labor, plus a few hundred dollars in fixed fees and ~\$100–700/month to run at launch traffic. At 100,000 users, budget ~\$3,000–8,000/month, with AI/LLM usage — not servers — usually the largest line.

A separate document, [GamerGain-Launch-Cost-Reconciliation.pdf](#) , shows how the pre-built execution kit can reduce the hour count (and therefore the labor cost) below this baseline if desired.